

Conflict of Interest Policy for USC Paid Employees

Authority: Chief Operating Officer	Date Ratified: April 28, 2025
	Next Review Date: April, 2028
Previous Amendments: February 2, 2024; February 2021	
Related Document(s):	
Review Committee(s): Human Resources Committee, Board of Directors	
Delegates: Senior Manager, People and Development	

PREAMBLE:

This policy reflects the USC's commitment to guarding against conflict of interest within the different bodies within the organization as it pertains to employment within the organization.

1. SCOPE

- 1.1. This policy applies to all paid USC employees identified in this policy including those compensated through honoraria (Full-time Staff, Coordinators, Associate Vice-Presidents, Interns, Orientation Staff, Elections Governance Board Members, Executive Officers, and Members of the Gazette).

2. DEFINITIONS

- 2.1. **Conflict of Interest** means a situation in which a person or organization is involved in multiple interests, financial or otherwise, and serving one interest could involve working against another or benefiting from another.

3. ADMINISTRATION

- 3.1. The Senior Manager, People and Development is responsible for administering the provisions of this Policy. In the event the Senior Manager, People and Development is conflicted, the Chief Operating Officer shall be responsible for administering the Policy.
- 3.2. All issues pertaining to matters of Conflict of Interest as defined in this policy should be brought forward to the Senior Manager, People and Development.
- 3.3. The responsibility for application, enforcement, training, and communication of this policy shall lie with the Senior Manager, People and Development.

4. GENERAL STATEMENT

- 4.1. Employees of the USC are expected to adhere to the highest standards of personal and professional integrity and shall protect the interests of the USC. Personal gain shall not conflict with duty to the USC.

5. EXPECTATIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

- 5.1. Paid employees of the USC including salaried, part-time, full-time, staff paid through honoraria shall hold one position with the USC at a time.
- 5.2. USC Volunteers who are not compensated by the USC may hold multiple unpaid volunteer positions.
- 5.3. Paid employees of the USC including salaried, full-time, staff paid through honoraria and Faculty Leadership Soph Team (LST) members and Faculty Sophs may not apply or run for a position as a USC Councillor, USC Director who sits on the USC Board of Directors, USC Purple Care Trust Student Trustee, USC Appeals Board Member while they hold one of these positions.
- 5.4. Paid employees who apply for a hired executive position will not be required to take a leave of absence as it will be treated as an internal hiring process.
- 5.5. Employees of the USC shall not use corporate resources for the purposes of personal or political gain.
- 5.6. Consultations for USC hired and elected student leadership positions shall go through the President and Vice-Presidents.

6. COMMUNICATION

- 6.1. This policy will be explained as needed to workers through orientation or task-specific training, and will be included in new hire paperwork.
- 6.2. All Members will be trained on this policy annually.

7. EVALUATION

- 7.1. This policy shall be reviewed annually and as needed through the Continuous Improvement Policy for Human Resources Policies.